

Here is the arc ACB , a piece of curve fixed in position, rising from the point of contact A up through C to a nearby point B . The phrase *continuous curvature* means the curve bends *smoothly* — at every point, including A , it has one definite direction and no sharp corner. This smoothness is Newton's standing assumption, the supposition he will not let go of. This arc is the object whose ultimate behaviour near A we mean to investigate.